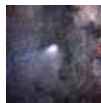




More security for Zeta!

Zeta has introduced security feature allowing friends to secure our mobile wallet.



Venus messing Halley

Studies have revealed that Venus is responsible for messing with Halley's comet occurrence. digit.in/VenXHalley

Bluetooth Speakers



BUILD AND DESIGN

CREATIVE SOUND BLASTER ROAR

The Roar is essentially a rectangular slab and conventionally one would imagine there isn't much that can be done aesthetically with a monolithic structure like that. The product designers have still managed to put in some eye candy with its machined grille and ample chroming on the sides. The design now looks a little dated and it is the bulkiest of the four speakers. It would have certainly been more appealing had the much improved Roar 2 not been right in front of us.

The Sound Blaster Roar has rubber strips on its rear ends, and placing it flat on a desk is the ideal position. The rubber strips keep the speaker in place so that it does not vibrate, but as a disadvantage, you cannot place it upright. The bottom panel houses the bass drivers, which get completely muted if you place the speaker upright. This is a design flaw, which Creative has thankfully fixed in the Roar 2. Overall, the Sound Blaster Roar has a neat layout, but not one that really strikes or appeals to you.

CREATIVE SOUND BLASTER ROAR 2

The Sound Blaster Roar 2 looks a lot like its predecessor, at least superficially. However the beauty isn't just skin deep in this case. If you look at the driver placement, the Roar 2 is a much-improved design, weighing 10 percent lesser in a smaller body. The buttons are shifted towards the left of the front panel, and the steel grey finish has been replaced with black livery. Unlike the Roar, the Sound Blaster Roar 2 has a plastic bottom plate, although stabilising rubber strips are missing here.

That's as much as the new design goes, and the Roar 2 still remains a neat yet ordinary-looking speaker. There is nothing really exceptional to write about, unless you happen to be a fan of speakers that resembles the good old radio transistors of olden days. The Roar 2 also feels more sturdy in terms of build, and may even withstand a drop or two when subjected to the same.

ULTIMATE EARS BOOM 2

Logitech's UE Boom 2 looks like it was designed to grab your attention. The colours and rubberised body will instantly attract attention. While the design is on the ostentatious side, it retains a bright, joyous playfulness about it with the bright colour combinations and a cylindrical shape which makes it easy to fit literally anywhere. It does fit anywhere, although its funky bearings make it look more at place in a messier room with a faded Stratocaster and rugged denims. The construction is solid, and the Aux-in and microUSB ports are sealed with rubber flaps for using in swimming pools. You also get a tripod mount, should you wish to bolt it to your bike's rig on a mountain hike.

The only qualms here are the buttons not being the easiest in terms of usage. The Boom 2 may also not go well if you are looking for a speaker with quiet, understated elegance. The Boom 2 is not exactly a loud design out there in the market, but it isn't the most suave either.

B&O BEOPLAY A1

This is Bang & Olufsen's budget offering with an entry-segment luxury product, and it really shows. The Beoplay A1 looks somewhere between a beautifully glorified carrom striker and a collectible container. The minimalistic design will appeal to a wide section, and goes well with its excellent performance output. The design feels like it'll be right at home in an art studio and even a messy bachelor pad. Being able to complement any setting is quite a testament to its adaptive design. The bottom of the speaker is rubber to prevent vibration on desks, and a genuine leather strap will let you hang it on the wall. The circular design also helps in audio distribution.

The buttons, all laid in to the rubber panel, are reasonably well responsive, and there is literally no flaw to observe here. It is nearly as light as the UE Boom 2, and happens to be the only speaker among these four that uses Aluminium in its build. B&O's products have always been geared towards being a lifestyle product, and that is exactly what the Beoplay A1 achieves.

Build and Design

Materials used82
Aesthetics70
Score76/100

Build and Design

Materials used82
Aesthetics80
Score81/100

Build and Design

Materials used88
Aesthetics86
Score87/100

Build and Design

Materials used94
Aesthetics94
Score94/100